

Music

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Grade boundaries

Higher level overall

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 10	11 - 21	22 - 37	38 - 51	52 - 66	67 - 80	81 - 100

Standard level overall

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 10	11 - 20	21 - 36	37 - 50	51 - 63	64 - 76	77 - 100

Exploring music in context

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 2	3 - 4	5 - 7	8 - 10	11 - 13	14 - 16	17 - 24

Experimenting with music

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 2	3 - 4	5 - 10	11 - 14	15 - 17	18 - 21	22 - 28

Higher level the contemporary music maker

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 3	4 - 7	8 - 12	13 - 17	18 - 23	24 - 28	29 - 32

Presenting music

Grade:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Mark range:	0 - 5	6 - 10	11 - 16	17 - 21	22 - 27	28 - 32	33 - 38

Exploring music in context

The range and suitability of the work submitted

The distribution of marks predominantly falls within the 7–16 range. In this session, only a small proportion of students achieved scores with a mark above 20, while many submissions scored 10 or below.

There appears to be a lack of comprehensive understanding of the component requirements. Criteria C1 and C2, for instance, do not inherently reward musicality but rather they evaluate the comprehension of creating conventions and performance practices. Instances have been observed where students presented artistically compelling practical exercises but failed to adhere to the prescribed requirements outlined in the level descriptors. Consequently, these exercises, despite their artistic merit, did not receive high marks, or in some instances, any marks at all.

The selection of musical pieces critically impacted the quality of student submissions. Frequently, students selected pieces based on personal preference rather than on their potential for effective analysis. This issue was compounded by the widespread misunderstanding of the concept of contexts; for example, the term “global” was often misinterpreted to denote pieces that are well-known internationally, significantly compromising the quality of analyses.

Additionally, there were numerous instances where the Area of Inquiry (AOI) and context of each piece were inadequately identified or justified. Some students limited their exploration to only two pieces, thereby neglecting one of the required contexts. Conversely, others analyzed an excessive number of pieces, thereby preventing a meaningful analysis of each individual piece.

Too often, students included pieces to satisfy C1 and C2 criteria that had not been adequately researched, which was reflected in the corresponding marks for these criteria. While there were a few well-conceived submissions, a considerable number of students fundamentally misunderstood the requirements, resulting in essays with little or no analysis of the pieces, which were only briefly mentioned.

Student performance against each criterion

As in all sessions, there were some truly compelling submissions. However, this section focusses upon describing areas that need attention from supervisors and students. In the section “Recommendation for the supervision of future students” there is a brief analysis of those cases where students reached high marks to be used as examples for subsequent sessions.

Criterion A

Most submissions presented a varied selection of music, yet there were several common issues across the submissions. Score extracts were frequently provided without sources, and in-text referencing was often lacking. Many students confined their research to the first website they encountered on the internet, resulting in an inconsistent quality of evidence and referencing.

Overall, most students scored 2 or 3 marks out of 6. While nearly all students addressed a minimum of two AOI and listed at least two contexts, they often failed to justify these choices adequately, particularly for contexts. The evidence ranged from rudimentary to purposeful and was often annotated, though the use of academic referencing showed an improvement compared to previous sessions.

There was a notable confusion about AOI3, with many students listing it as music for entertainment without understanding its link to drama or choreographed movement. While the majority of students

chose two distinct AOs and mentioned at least two contexts, only around half effectively justified how their selections fitted into the chosen contexts and AOs. Inconsistent use of evidence, both musical and in-text citations, was observed in a number of submissions. The overall quality of exploration ranged from superior to less than rudimentary.

Most students succeeded in selecting pieces that demonstrated diversity, although occasionally the breadth was lacking. Contexts were not considered by several students, but when they were, the music's relationship to the student was clear. However, there was a recurring misunderstanding of "context," with several students incorrectly referring to geographical location. AOs were usually identified, but pieces were not always correctly placed within these AOs.

Audio uploads were sometimes inaccurate in content or timings as indicated on the cover sheet. While most written works included some form of referencing, there were occasional lapses, such as paraphrasing without attribution and notation without citation. In some instances, evidence was merely decorative, but most students who used notation did so to support points raised.

Many students included scores or screenshots, but some did not append any form of support to their submissions. This inconsistency in providing evidence impacted the overall effectiveness of their submissions.

Criterion B1

Much of the analysis lacked depth and detail, with few students discussing findings that supported the AOs. Extra-musical findings tended to be somewhat irrelevant, while musical findings were often superficial. The primary issue was that the musical findings were frequently descriptive and basic, such as noting the tempo or the presence of certain note values, without deeper analysis of how musical elements were used in the pieces. Additionally, time-stamps often related to the original recording rather than the uploads. Musical terminology varied significantly, ranging from incorrect or rudimentary to some excellent cases. Some submissions included comments that were unsupported by evidence.

Several students managed to provide some contextual information, but many struggled to relate the pieces back to the AOs through their musical findings. This difficulty was less pronounced for extra-musical findings, where the AOs were often clearly referred to. Analyses ranged from non-existent to mostly reasonable and occasionally competent, though it was clear that many students had issues with music theory, such as inaccurate descriptions of harmonic content.

Many students stuck to the basics of key, tempo, metre, and instrumentation without providing detailed commentary on how these elements were employed. In general, appropriate musical terms were used, but students often mentioned them in passing rather than applying them meaningfully in their analysis. The location of findings was haphazard in many submissions, with missing bar numbers on quotes and inconsistent referencing.

Criterion B2

This is an area that saw difficulty for students, often due to a lack of understanding of the requirements of this criteria. Students frequently used pieces that were not part of the designated exploration, which indicated a misunderstanding of the guidelines. Consequently, such analyses lacked depth and relevance.

Students also struggled to articulate purposeful implications between the stimuli and the practical exercises for both the creating exercise and the adaptation. While some achieved satisfactory marks by following instructions, a notable portion did not adhere to the guidelines that are outlined in the Music

Guide. They selected stimulus pieces not explored earlier in the portfolio, further compromising the coherence of their submissions.

Additionally, students tended to focus more on describing the process rather than exploring its implications. This imbalance hindered students' ability to effectively analyze the relationship between a stimulus and a practical exercise. Moreover, some stimulus music choices were inappropriate, making it challenging for students to identify and articulate meaningful implications.

Addressing these challenges requires a clearer understanding of the requirements outlined in the Music Guide and a more thoughtful selection of stimulus repertory that aligns with the exploration objectives. Emphasizing the importance of identifying and articulating purposeful implications will also be crucial in enhancing the quality and coherence of future submissions.

Criterion C1

In terms of practical exercises, students generally demonstrated greater success in their creating exercises compared to the adaptation. While most were able to exhibit some discernible influence of the stimulus piece on their creating exercise, achieving maximum points was rare.

For criterion C1, there were numerous intriguing and inventive submissions. However, some lacked reference to a studied style, while others attempted to emulate specific pieces that students had researched without grasping the broader style. A musical element found in a piece is not necessarily a convention. Consequently, few creating conventions were identified in these instances.

Criterion C2

This criterion also posed significant challenges for many students, indicating a widespread struggle to comprehend its requirements. There appears to be a lack of understanding regarding what is expected for the performed adaptation. Many students submitted what could be deemed as simple transcriptions or performances, lacking any evidence of grasping performance practices.

Moreover, it is evident that the concept of adaptation remains elusive for many students. Many submissions featured renditions of the melody line or arrangements, with numerous submissions failing to grasp the distinction between adaptation, arrangement, and transcription. Notably, a concerning trend emerged where students submitted pieces identified as personal contexts, rather than the permitted local or global context.

While there were commendable submissions that clearly demonstrated an understanding of shaping performance practices based on the stimulus, these were overshadowed by numerous renditions that closely mirrored the stimuli, often lacking thoughtful consideration of performance practices. Some students merely adapted piano pieces for piano or guitar pieces for guitar, failing to showcase a deeper understanding of adaptation.

Recommendations and guidance for the teaching of future students

Criterion A

Selections for the exploration should not only demonstrate diversity but also fall at least into two distinct AOs. It is crucial that students provide explanations for why these selections are placed within these AOs and contexts. Additionally, the use of references and citations as well as musical evidence is essential to support effective musical analysis.

To enhance the quality of their exploration, students are advised to select at least one piece for the exploration whose creating conventions they can identify, and another whose performance practices they can identify. Choosing three pieces ensures that all contexts are addressed comprehensively.

Clear understanding of contexts and AOIs is paramount, especially the global context and the interpretation of “music for dramatic impact, movement and entertainment” as AOI 3. Guidance regarding the audio reference material is also crucial. When audio extracts are insufficiently long, do not match the written work, or are arranged differently from the written work, the usefulness of the audio reference material diminishes, making it challenging to understand the student's intentions and justifications. Also, it is very important that audio quality should be high.

Criterion B1

Musical findings require greater depth beyond superficial descriptions of the score. Students who achieved high marks in this criterion provided relevant findings. Anecdotal comments fail to explain what a convention entails. Moreover, evidence presented in scripts should not refer to external sources such as YouTube links; instead, it should be available within the provided uploads with accurate time-stamps or in conventional notation. To enhance clarity, the location of analytical findings should be annotated on the score or indicated using time-stamps. Students should be encouraged to employ accurate terminology, evidence, and location.

Furthermore, musical findings of selected pieces should go beyond general descriptions and incorporate several instances of relevant details. Musical evidence should be based on fragments uploaded rather than referencing original recording time-stamps, as this can be irrelevant in the examining context.

Criterion B2

Students who performed better in this criterion demonstrated a rounded understanding of the component, viewing it as an integrated process rather than a series of disjointed steps. They recognized that the exploration outlined in section 1 served as the foundation for both 'creation' and 'adaptation' in sections 2 and 3, respectively. By grasping this interconnectedness, these students found it straightforward to articulate the implications effectively.

Criterion C1

A convention serves as a link between different musical styles. Those who scored highly understood that not every element found in a particular piece constitutes a convention. For example, if a folk song has a metre of 4/4, it does not imply that all folk songs follow the same metre. Similarly, if a popular piece is in F major, it does not imply that all popular pieces share the same key. Therefore, such elements do not qualify as conventions. Students must differentiate between particular musical elements and those that form part of a conventional usage.

Criterion C2

It is recommended that time is taken to explain to students the concept of performance practices and what is expected for this criterion. Students who understand the concept of performance practices are better placed to achieve the higher marks on this criterion.

Further comments

Piano reductions are not suitable when discussing orchestral pieces and referencing instrumentation. MuseScore generated scores, while frequently used, are often inaccurate and not considered reliable

evidence. It is imperative that chord progressions, rhythms, and melodies be notated rather than described in letters, and explaining notated quotes is best achieved through annotation. Utilizing notated quotes provides clear evidence, and students should ensure accuracy in time-stamps, avoiding ranges that require the examiner to search for specific points.

Additionally, it is unnecessary to discuss musical content outside the excerpt unless it directly pertains to it, and excerpts should be carefully chosen to facilitate detailed discussion. Students must specify which pieces inform their submissions at C1 and C2.

Finally, a thorough review of the Music Guide is essential, as many errors in submissions could have been easily resolved by following its instructions. Investing time in better understanding it would likely yield improved results than focusing solely on the task itself.

There is a clear need for both teachers and students to have a better understanding of the requirements for practical exercises. There were many instances of non-compliance of instructions, such as using stimuli not explored in section 1 or personal pieces for adaptation.

Experimenting with music

The range and suitability of the work submitted

Examiners encountered work covering almost the full range of marks. The lowest scoring work was generally incomplete. Few examiners had the opportunity to give full marks in this session.

Overall, work was suitable to the task, although the understanding of performance experimentation is still developing. Experiments in performing were slightly stronger this session and tended to concentrate on more conventional development of musical elements rather than feeling the necessity to go for extreme techniques. However, experimenting with performance continues to be widely misunderstood, and several students submitted performing experiments with a strong creating content.

There is room for improvement with attribution of sources. Too often students merely name a piece of music, often failing to mention the composer, particularly when the composer and performer are not the same.

In this session, more schools presented excerpts of an experimental process (three experiments in a progressive series) than in previous sessions, but still more than half of the responses featured sets of experiments that were exercises complete in themselves, usually, but not always, related to a single stimulus. A progressive series of experiments would be evaluated for its “transformation of ideas” mostly by the final excerpt, with the preceding excerpts being considered preparatory, or even a kind of research, whereas in the case of three separate exercises the examiner would need to evaluate this transformation in each of the three different situations and then calculate an overall mark.

Experiments in creating using publishing programmes (MuseScore/Sibelius/Finale) and experiments using digital workstations were roughly equal in number.

Many students in their creating experiments chose to work in music from a genre without citing specific stimulus music.

Students who chose to work with music technology were often very good at explaining their technical decisions, but were sometimes vague when discussing musical choices. For example, there were instances of indefinite phrases such as “I added some chords.”

The requirement to include Areas of Inquiry and contexts was better observed this session, although there remain ambiguities as to whether the AOI refers to the stimulus music or to the method of work. (A Bach Sonata reworked on a DAW might be AOI2 or 4 for example.) Most students made some attempt to justify their choices of AOI and context.

Most students managed to present experiments in creating and performing in different AOIs and contexts, although sometimes this was achieved via the somewhat creative definition of these.

Student performance against each criterion

Criteria A and C

There were many generic, undeveloped reports, and subject specific vocabulary skills could be very weak. Lower scoring rationales missed important points, lacked purpose, or presented irrelevant information. Some did not explain what the experimentation would be.

Reference to research continues to be often brief or even absent. Students who clearly attributed primary and secondary stimuli and showed application of findings from research were the higher scorers in A and C.

Ongoing evaluation of the process was given by fewer than half of the students. This evaluation was more common in cases where the experiments were progressive/linear.

In general, performing rationales were shorter than the creating rationales.

Criterion B

Some students set out to take a stimulus and to work it into a chosen new context, whereas others presented a genre or artist and said they were going to create in this fashion. The evaluation of “development of musical ideas” (criteria B and D) was problematic when those ideas were not coming from a stimulus (source material) but rather created by the student. These students were effectively limiting themselves to “recreating”, although stronger students managed to personalize the generic elements.

The term “adapts” continues to be a problem due to its implying the adjustment of elements to a new context, which may be external to the student’s creating process, whereas “transforming” allows the student to create their own new context. Adapting might therefore be seen as an alternative to transforming rather than something inferior.

Practical work with a specific stimulus and sources progressively through the three experiments generally fared better than submissions of one stimulus per experiment.

Experimentation goals were not always realistic or attainable; some were beyond the student’s abilities (e.g. writing for string quartet, symphony orchestra, fugue and counterpoint projects without understanding common practice, or swing and jazz improvisation, in some cases). In other cases sophisticated experiments were well realized.

Criterion D

Audio evidence of experimenting in performing showed a wide variety in quality, considering also that students ranged from accomplished players to those who had been playing their instruments for possibly less than two years.

Stronger students showed an openness to trying things out, using the various parameters available to them – sometimes going to extended, or unusual techniques. Weaker students performed with little or no discernible variation from the original.

The element of improvisation sometimes helped a student personalize their rendering of a piece. Improvisation was used almost exclusively in performing experiments rather than as a creating activity.

Some students included creating elements in their performing experiments, presenting performances of what were effectively rearrangements. These generally scored less well than others since the development of musical ideas was not being achieved through performance. This remains a grey area in the component.

Only a small minority of students offered performing experiments using technology, and fortunately these were presented in such a way as to be able to appreciate and evaluate the “live” performing aspect.

Recommendations and guidance for the teaching of future students

It is important to note that the inclusion and effective justification of AOI and context impacts the mark awarded for the effectiveness of the rationale provided.

Conducting additional research will enable students to make more informed choices and enhance the overall suitability of their work. The experimenting component should encourage imagination, and might even include some 'leaping in the dark', as it were, which may lead to discoveries.

It is important that students understand how keen discipline, planned and informed research and trialling are essential to artistic work.

The relationship between research and the experimenting process is not always coming over strongly. Students should try to show what it is they are taking from the research to apply into the experimentation process.

Teachers should direct their students to explain the decisions in their experimentation process, rather than simply list what they do.

Students should remember to offer some evaluation after each experimenting excerpt. This may even be a negative evaluation if the student feels the experiment has not produced a useful result.

Students should be clear of the differences between creating and performing decisions. It is important that teachers and students understand that experimentation in performance is not an exercise in music reading development, or a process of learning to play or sing, or even a creation experiment (arrangements, work with composition/creation variables). In performing experiments, the student should show the desire to change a stimulus through performing it in a different way. This does not have to be a new or unconventional way, just a different way that will bring about some change.

Some creating audio uploads were quite short. Students should try to make full use of the time they are given.

From the work submitted it was obvious that some schools have all students doing the same tasks, especially in experimenting as a creator. This may be a useful method when students lack an idea of where to start from, but it may also, in some cases, be taking away from students the freedom to play to their strengths.

Students should establish meaningful discussions of AOI and contexts for the study of music from the very beginning.

When uploading audio tracks, it is helpful to leave a few seconds between each excerpt as audio excerpts that run together can be problematic for the examiner.

Uploaded work should be free of teachers' comments.

Higher level the contemporary music maker

The range and suitability of the work submitted

The May 2024 assessment of the Contemporary Music Maker (CMM) component exhibited a wide range of submitted work, closely mirroring the characteristics and issues observed in the previous year's cohort. Despite the interesting variety of projects, the suitability and efficiency of the works submitted remained a challenge for many students.

In terms of scope and focus, most submissions lacked detailed musical analysis and robust evidence to support their projects, often prioritising non-musical aspects. However, the strength of the projects continued to lie in meticulous project planning.

Regarding the quality of projects, the majority were creations (composition, songwriting, producing), yet many lacked sufficient control and development of material, especially for higher level (HL) students. This is an area that continues to require further improvement and guidance.

The use of supporting documents varied significantly. Many students missed opportunities to effectively utilise these documents to enhance their submissions, opting instead for transcriptions or summaries of their presentations. Some students did submit comprehensive scores, demonstrating deeper engagement with the component's requirements.

In terms of collaboration and leadership, while students understood the importance of collaboration, many struggled to demonstrate clear leadership within their designated role as outlined in the Music Guide. A recurring issue was students interpreting "role" in the plural rather than singular, contrary to the guideline's requirement for a singular role identification, leading to statements like "my roles have been singer and composer". Only one role can be considered in assessment.

Student performance against each criterion

Criterion A

The majority of the evidence focused on planning and was typically presented as a PowerPoint presentation with voice-over. Only a few students achieved full marks by showcasing both musical and research evidence. Some students effectively included score excerpts and videos of their practice or rehearsals. However, in many cases, there was no concrete evidence of collaboration beyond the student's voice discussing it during the presentation. The main issues were the absence of quality research, a bibliography, and scores as evidence.

Criterion B

This criterion continues to be the most challenging. Only a few students effectively discussed the entire process necessary to achieve full marks. Many students dedicated significant time to discussing planning and lacked sufficient space to delve into the process in relation to their stated aims. Examples in the top mark band were hard to find, as many students did not thoroughly discuss challenges and successes, examine areas for development and improvement, or evaluate their musical and collaborative choices. Most students did not address all three bullet points of this criterion with enough depth, resulting in a lack of critical analysis and reflection in the majority of submissions.

Criterion C

When students adhered to submission requirements, this criterion was straightforward to mark, and some very good pieces were observed. However, issues arose when it was difficult or impossible to identify the student's work, particularly in collaborative projects. While sharing the composition process can be interesting, most examples focused on a simple melody with basic harmonic progressions. Effective collaborations involved a student composing while another managed production tasks such as recording, editing, mixing, and mastering. Some submissions lacked clear identification of students, making it challenging to evaluate individual contributions. Additionally, some students took on non-musical roles, such as organising a concert, building an instrument or writing lyrics, without focusing on musical intentions. If the same student was also a performer and provided evidence and discussion of their performance process, technical proficiency could be assessed more easily. Many submissions included film scores or compositions for art exhibitions, but well-edited scores were rare, with most compositions lacking any score at all. Students need to spend more time discussing musical elements in relation to their works. Analysis of key, chord structure, form, and DAW techniques was often lacking. Scores frequently had inaccurate rhythmic groupings and lacked performance directions. However, some examples of creating and performing were exceptional.

Criterion D

This criterion was straightforward to mark as presentations were generally purposeful. Many students were marked at a 3 for this criterion. Students still did not include enough variety in their presentations, relying too heavily on speaking to PowerPoint slides rather than engaging the viewer in the process through rehearsals, interviews, and other dynamic content.

Recommendations and guidance for the teaching of future students

Teachers and students should thoroughly review and compare both parts of the CMM component in the Music Guide. These are the syllabus components and the internal assessment part, particularly focusing on submission requirements. Understanding these components ensures alignment with assessment criteria, especially criterion B.

Students should be sure to take care in terms of clearly identifying 'who is who' in the submission. This can be achieved in a number of ways, but one effective means is the inclusion of a picture or video of the student. This clarity is crucial for accurately assessing individual contributions and roles in collaborative projects.

It is important to submit original material, especially in arrangements. Many submissions lacked the original material necessary to effectively assess arrangement skills.

In cases of collaboration where students share the composition process of the same piece, students should establish clear leadership roles for each presentation. Students should also develop the music in a detailed way, to demonstrate excellent technical proficiency, showcasing their individual contributions within the collaborative framework.

Supporting documents are important in enhancing presentations. These documents should enrich the understanding and depth of their creative process and musical intentions.

Teachers should encourage students to include as much variety as possible in their multimedia presentations. Over-reliance on speaking to PowerPoint (PPT) slides alone should be discouraged.

Incorporate dynamic elements such as rehearsals, interviews, and behind-the-scenes footage to engage the audience effectively.

Provide greater guidance to students throughout the project, emphasising the explicit evidence of collaboration in the creative process. Ensure students submit their work independently, even when collaborating, to accurately assess individual contributions.

Teachers should ensure students have sufficient time to complete the project within the recommended hours. Encourage thorough documentation of the entire process to ensure a comprehensive and varied final presentation.

Further comments

This component should be approached comprehensively, integrating the roles of researcher, performer, and creator. The chosen musical role should align closely with the project's objectives.

It is crucial to adhere strictly to the submission requirements to ensure students receive appropriate marks for their efforts. Therefore, teachers and students are urged to thoroughly review the Music Guide for detailed instructions. While the Guide provides clear directions, attention to specific details such as specifying the primary assessed role, collaborating with peers (excluding adults/teachers/professionals), adhering to the 15-minute presentation limit, and presenting the final product comprehensively is essential.

Presenting music

The range and suitability of the work submitted

Work submitted this session did not always demonstrate an understanding of what is required in this component. The creating works were mostly suitable although there were some improvisations which did not clearly show the plan behind the work. Some creating works did not have scores in the programme. This session, there were a number of collaborative compositions where it was difficult at times to determine the role of the individual student in the creative process. In the performed works, the majority of the solo performances had suitable accompaniment rather than backing tracks, although some pieces were still lacking any sort of accompaniment when one was required. Although not mandatory, there were very few music technology performances submitted. Many ensemble performances were submitted although quite a few did not have extracts of the student playing or singing as an individual. The audio quality was generally good although there were still some unsuitable recordings submitted.

Student performance against each criterion

Criterion A

Generally, the programme notes contained all the AOs, though these were not always suitably linked, discussed or explained. There were quite a few submissions without scores. Some bibliographies had excellent sources but many only supplied YouTube videos or music scores. The researcher role seemed to be a little neglected this session. Most programme notes did not include footnotes/references and only very few had an academic tone.

Criterion B

Creating showed a varying range of composing and improvising. Often the works were very short without much, if any, development and were quite repetitive. There were, however, impressive works which were compelling, and which demonstrated an advanced understanding of orchestration and writing in different styles.

Criterion C

There were some excellent performances both as soloists and as members of ensemble with extracts to show evidence of the student's level. There were some performances, however, that were hesitant and needed better preparation. As mentioned earlier, extracts were often neglected in the recordings provided.

Criterion D

When the AOs were identified adequately, the communication of the roles was apparent. There was musical expression in the majority of the submissions. The audio quality was acceptable for the most part although some of the ensemble recordings were of lesser quality.

Recommendations and guidance for the teaching of future students

The connections between AOs and selections in creating and performing need to be clearly linked and explained. Students should choose works for Presenting early in the course and work on musical

communication over time and not at the last minute in order to provide appropriate commentary on the works in relation to the AOI.

Students should avoid personal reminiscence or overly long discourse on non-musical points in the programme notes.

In performing, intonation is part of technical proficiency and should be an equal priority with all the other elements of music. Ensembles should be of high quality and extracts are necessary to understand the level of the student within the ensemble.

The instrumentation of the student needs to be written clearly. If the student is playing several instruments or singing as well as playing an instrument, then that needs to be written in the 6/MPM form and in the programme notes. It is wise also to consider if there is any advantage in including works played on more than one instrument/singing. It is rarely the case that a musician has equal technical facility on more than one instrument, so it may therefore be more beneficial for a student to include another work on their stronger instrument rather than include works played on another instrument upon which the student has weaker technique.

It is recommended that more time be put into teaching students how to approach the creating section of this component. Analysis and understanding of a range of advanced musical works will aid students in giving depth to their creating.

Students using DAW for composing need to be creating their own original loops. They should not use pre-recorded loops available in the programs being used. Teachers are encouraged to consciously assist students in DAW creating as they would using more traditional forms of composition.

Arrangements, mashups, and adaptations are not part of Presenting in Music, and so should not be included in the creating section. Collaborative compositions should be avoided as they leave a question as to the role of the student in the creating.

Further comments

Students should use as much as possible of the time allowed for creating and performing as this gives many more opportunities to show evidence of the quality of the student's creating and performing. They should try to obtain the best quality audio in a live performance setting avoiding people talking over the performance. The programme notes need to be as clear as possible.